

2026 U.S. Open Fantasy Golf Tier Sheet — Shinnecock Hills (June 18-21, 2026)

Bottom line: Scottie Scheffler is the clear, standalone £4M anchor at a consensus ~+520, and the only defensible same-tier overrides this week are an injury demotion of Brooks Koepka (£3M→£2M) and hot-form promotions of major champion Aaron Rai and RBC Canadian Open winner Bud Cauley within the £2M tier — everything else defers to the odds-then-form methodology. The field is confirmed at exactly 156 (USGA announced the completed field June 14, 2026), so tier sizes hold at 6 / 15 / 45 / 90. Shinnecock plays as a 7,434-yard par-70 with roughly 5-inch fescue rough and 150-plus bunkers, putting a heavy premium on driving accuracy and ball-striking, and its cut to the low 60 scores and ties (no 10-shot rule since 2011) is the harshest in major golf — under 40% of the field is projected to reach the weekend. That cut profile drives the entire build strategy below.

Correction note (this version): An earlier draft listed only 87 names in the £1M tier. The tier was reconciled name-by-name against the official field, which surfaced three players who had been omitted — **Padraig Harrington, Michael Brennan, and Eric Lee (a)** — all now placed in £1M. The tier is now a correct 90 and the full sheet sums to 156. No £2M (or higher) player was moved. See *Process Notes / Overrides Applied*.

TL;DR

- **£4M is Scheffler (~+520, nearly 2x shorter than anyone), then McIlroy and Rahm, then a three-way near-tie among Cameron Young, Xander Schauffele and Matt Fitzpatrick** — Young earns rank 4 on a form tiebreaker (2026 Players + Cadillac wins, Masters T3).
- **One injury override applied:** Koepka demoted £3M→£2M (verified active hand injury, WD from the RBC Canadian Open final round June 14). Morikawa was checked and is **NOT** demoted — his back issue is verified historical (March 2026) and he has since played 6+ events including two majors and the Canadian Open.
- **Play 3-3-2-2 (or 4-2-2-2 with Scheffler).** With under 40% of the field making the weekend, prioritize proven cut-makers (Scheffler, Schauffele, Henley, Matsuyama, Harris English) over high-variance bombers picked purely for win equity.

Key Findings

- **Consensus odds (DraftKings / FanDuel / BetMGM):** Scheffler ~+520 (DK +460, FD/BetMGM +550); McIlroy ~+1050; Rahm ~+1175. The gap from Scheffler to the field is the defining feature of the board.
- **Form/odds divergence at the top:** Cameron Young (consensus ~+1950) has the strongest 2026 résumé of anyone outside the big three — he won THE PLAYERS and

went wire-to-wire to win the Cadillac Championship by six over Scheffler, plus a Masters T3 — so he ranks ahead of the cooling Schauffele despite near-identical odds.

- **Koepka book spread exceeds 30%** (DK +2400 vs FD/BetMGM +3500) — that disagreement is itself informational and tied directly to the injury; flagged.
- **Hot-form promotions:** Aaron Rai won the 108th PGA Championship at Aronimink (May 17, 2026) at 9-under 271 by three shots over Rahm and Smalley — the first English-born winner of the Wanamaker Trophy since Jim Barnes in 1919; and Bud Cauley won the 2026 RBC Canadian Open on June 14 by two shots over Fitzpatrick (closing 65, 17-under 263) — his first PGA Tour win in his 239th start, which jumped him 28 spots to No. 40 in the world and into the field.
- **Roughly 43 spots filled via final qualifying.** Medalists worth elevating above the journeyman pack: Chris Kirk (-15, Ball Ground), Davis Thompson (-11, Columbus), Emiliano Grillo (-9, Ontario), plus Nathan Kimsey (Walton Heath), Kevin Roy (Purchase) and co-medalists Neal Shipley/Zac Blair (Springfield).

£4M Tier (6) — ranked purely by consensus odds (shortest = rank 1)

1. **Scottie Scheffler** (~+520; DK +460 / FD +550 / BetMGM +550). World No. 1, leads the PGA Tour in Strokes Gained: Total and Tee-to-Green. Pursuing the career Grand Slam and turns 30 on Sunday. Memorial T12 (extending his made-cut streak to 76, the Tour's longest) with four top-3s in his last six starts. Best cut security in the field.
2. **Rory McIlroy** (~+1050). 2026 Masters champion, PGA T7; six top-10s in his last seven U.S. Opens. The single worry is driving accuracy (ranked 125th) against the fescue.
3. **Jon Rahm** (~+1175). PGA Championship runner-up; heavy ball flight handles wind, and he has six straight U.S. Open cuts since missing here in 2018.
4. **Cameron Young** (~+1950). **Form tiebreaker over Schauffele:** 2026 Players + Cadillac wins and a Masters T3. Long and accurate; ranks top-7 in bogey avoidance and scrambling — exactly the par-grinding profile a 1-over winning score rewards.
5. **Xander Schauffele** (~+1950). Has never finished worse than T14 in nine U.S. Opens and owns the field's best career U.S. Open scoring average (70.33). Form has cooled (no win since the 2025 Baycurrent Classic), which is why he sits behind Young on the same odds.
6. **Matt Fitzpatrick** (~+2100). 2022 U.S. Open champion, three 2026 PGA Tour wins, and RBC Canadian Open runner-up last week. Low, wind-piercing ball flight and elite scrambling; edges Fleetwood/Åberg for the final elite slot.

£3M Tier (15) — ranked by consensus odds, form as tiebreaker

1. **Tommy Fleetwood** (~+2150). Owns the Shinnecock course record — his final-round 63 in 2018 tied for the lowest score in U.S. Open history, finishing runner-up. Reigning FedExCup champ, but no top-10 in his last nine majors — a backdoor risk.

2. **Ludvig Åberg** (~+2350). Second on Tour in SG: Total, PGA T4, red-hot spring. The caution is a 0-for-11 major record and an MC here last year at Oakmont.
3. **Bryson DeChambeau** (~+2600). Two-time U.S. Open champion, but **missed the cut at both 2026 majors** — a real odds/form divergence. Held at his odds tier per the default rule (no injury/clear-form override), but flagged.
4. **Russell Henley** (~+3500). OWGR top-10, Masters T3, five top-10s in his last eight majors. Precision profile fits perfectly; a live first-time-major-winner case.
5. **Collin Morikawa** (~+3700). **NOT demoted** (see Overrides). Elite driving accuracy and approach — ideal for the venue. Back issue is historical, not active.
6. **Wyndham Clark** (~+3900). 2023 U.S. Open champion; his LACC win profile (wide fairways, hot putter) echoes Shinnecock's width.
7. **Sam Burns** (~+3900). Back-to-back U.S. Open top-10s (T7 in 2025); slow Canadian Open weekend is noise against Masters T7 form.
8. **Si Woo Kim** (~+4100). DataGolf top-10 and a strong par-70 record.
9. **Justin Rose** (~+4100). T10 here in 2018, Masters T3, three top-3s in his last seven majors; a 2026 PGA Tour winner.
10. **Tyrrell Hatton** (~+4200). T4 at the 2025 U.S. Open, T6 here in 2018, Masters T3 — strong recent major pedigree.
11. **Justin Thomas** (~+4300). PGA T4, Players T8; excellent on par-70 courses and sharp tee-to-green since back surgery.
12. **Chris Gotterup** (~+4600). PGA T10, OWGR top-20, trending up.
13. **Patrick Cantlay** (~+4800). Nine made cuts in 10 U.S. Opens — a reliable lineup piece — but the putter caps his win equity.
14. **Patrick Reed** (~+5000). T4 here in 2018; Masters T12, PGA T10 in 2026. Elite from close range; arguably the best value in the tier.
15. **Viktor Hovland** (~+5000). Third at the 2025 U.S. Open and T3 at the Canadian Open last week; PGA MC is the only blemish.

£2M Tier (45) — blended rank (~60% consensus odds / 40% recent form), course fit breaks ties

1. **J.J. Spaun** (~+5500) — defending champion; elite ball-striking season.
2. **Aaron Rai** (~+8700) — **STRONG HOT-FORM PROMOTE: 2026 PGA champion** (9-under 271 at Aronimink, by three). Won on precision, not power — began that week 160th on Tour in driving distance yet finished fourth in the field in strokes gained putting. Accuracy maven who fits Shinnecock as well as anyone in this tier.
3. **Hideki Matsuyama** (~+6000) — 12 made cuts in 13 U.S. Opens with seven top-20s; premier cut-maker.
4. **Robert MacIntyre** (~+6200) — 2025 U.S. Open runner-up.

5. **Jordan Spieth** (~+6500) — Masters T12, PGA T18; ball-striking trending and a short-game profile that historically wins at Shinnecock.
6. **Bud Cauley** (~+9600) — **MODERATE HOT-FORM PROMOTE: won the RBC Canadian Open June 14** (first win in his 239th start; jumped to OWGR No. 40). Full-strength field win warrants a promote, tempered by major-readiness.
7. **Shane Lowry** (~+6800) — T2 at the 2016 U.S. Open. **>30% book spread flagged.**
8. **Joaquin Niemann** (~+6700) — PGA T18.
9. **Ben Griffin** (~+7700) — PGA T14; T10 in his only prior U.S. Open.
10. **Kurt Kitayama** (~+7900) — PGA T10 with a closing 63.
11. **Maverick McNealy** (~+7700) — top-20 in all three 2026 majors he's played.
12. **Adam Scott** (~+7700) — 100th consecutive major start; Masters T24.
13. **Min Woo Lee** (~+7500) — PGA T18.
14. **Harris English** (~+8600) — **10 made cuts in 10 U.S. Opens** (3rd in 2021); a cut machine.
15. **Sepp Straka** (~+9000) — Players T8.
16. **Brooks Koepka** (consensus ~+3100) — **INJURY DEMOTE from £3M; TRAP.** Two-time U.S. Open champ and 2018 Shinnecock winner, but actively injured (see Overrides). Talent is £3M; risk is not.
17. **Kristoffer Reitan** (~+8600) — qualified here in 2018 as well; DataGolf top-30.
18. **Alex Smalley** (~+10500) — **PGA runner-up (T2)** form note; 54-hole leader at Aronimink.
19. **David Puig** (~+9400) — PGA T18.
20. **J.T. Poston** (~+11500) — surged into the OWGR top 60 to earn the exemption.
21. **Nicolai Hojgaard** (~+9600).
22. **Alex Noren** (~+10000) — T25 here in 2018; OWGR top-20.
23. **Ryan Gerard** (~+11000).
24. **Akshay Bhatia** (~+13500) — Players T13.
25. **Jason Day** (~+13000).
26. **Gary Woodland** (~+11500) — 2019 U.S. Open champion.
27. **Alex Fitzpatrick** (~+11500) — U.S. Open debut, strong DataGolf rank.
28. **Jake Knapp** (~+9400).
29. **Keegan Bradley** (~+14000) — Masters T21.
30. **Rickie Fowler** (~+11000) — **flag: odds/form divergence**, weak recent results behind the market price.
31. **Keith Mitchell** (~+14500) — final-qualifier (third, -12); pure ball-striker.
32. **Sahith Theegala** (~+15500).
33. **Jacob Bridgeman** (~+15500) — Players T5.

34. **Dustin Johnson** (~+16000) — 2016 champ; 14 cuts in 18 U.S. Opens.
35. **Cameron Smith** (~+16000) — PGA T7; short-game fit if he keeps it in play.
36. **Jackson Koivun (a)** (~+15000) — top-ranked amateur.
37. **Nick Taylor** (~+16500) — T23 in 2025.
38. **Corey Connors** (~+18000) — **TRAP: just 1 made cut in 7 U.S. Opens, WD in 2025.**
39. **Tom Kim** (~+18500).
40. **Daniel Berger** (~+20000) — T6 here in 2018.
41. **Sungjae Im** (~+21000).
42. **Brian Harman** (~+23000) — Players T11; T2 at the 2017 U.S. Open.
43. **Ryan Fox** (~+25000) — Canadian Open T8; two PGA Tour wins in 2025.
44. **Lucas Herbert** (~+25000).
45. **Max Greyserman** (~+25000) — PGA T14; final-qualifier (Purchase).

Trap-pick callouts within the £2M tier (risk warnings, same tier): Koepka (active hand injury), Connors (chronic U.S. Open cut failure: 1/7), Fowler (form lags the price). Across the tier, weight cut probability over win equity.

£1M Tier (90) — top 16 ranked with notes; remainder by OWGR/fallback (low confidence)

1. **Sam Stevens** (~+27000) — 3 made cuts in 3 U.S. Opens, T23 in 2025; best cut-maker signal in the tier.
2. **Michael Kim** (~+32000) — consistent, strong recent cut rate.
3. **Chris Kirk** — **final-qualifying MEDALIST (-15, Ball Ground)**; T12 at Oakmont in 2025 is his career-best U.S. Open. Form edge over the odds.
4. **Andrew Novak** (~+31000) — 2025 PGA Tour winner.
5. **Emiliano Grillo** — **final-qualifying medalist (-9, Ontario)**; established PGA Tour winner.
6. **Jackson Suber** — led the RBC Canadian Open after 54 holes; clearly in form.
7. **Matti Schmid** — PGA Championship first-round co-leader; qualified via FedExCup top 5.
8. **Davis Thompson** — **final-qualifying medalist (-11, Columbus)**; 2024 PGA Tour winner.
9. **Carlos Ortiz** — LIV; OWGR ~66.
10. **Billy Horschel** — qualified 68-65 (Springfield); former FedExCup champion.
11. **Michael Brennan** — **(added in correction)** exempt via top-60 OWGR (May 18, 2026); an ascending young pro who climbed into the world's top 60. Strongest paper skill signal in this sub-group, but a U.S. Open rookie, so cut risk on the fescue holds him

here rather than higher; field power rankings peg him ~71st (DataGolf/OWGR ~85).

Low-confidence within the tier given the rookie profile.

12. **Harry Hall** (~+18000) — 2025 PGA Tour winner.
13. **Ryo Hisatsune** — DP World Tour winner.
14. **Caleb Surratt** — LIV; young, high DataGolf ceiling.
15. **Peter Uihlein** — LIV; medaled at Dallas final qualifying.
16. **Nico Echavarria** — two-time PGA Tour winner.

Remainder (ranks 17–90), ordered by the fallback ladder — OWGR → DataGolf → home-tour results → qualifier performance → status floor — explicitly LOW CONFIDENCE and largely cosmetic below ~rank 25: Jayden Schaper, Sudarshan Yellamaraju, Ben Silverman, Pierceson Coody, Patrick Rodgers, Kevin Roy (Purchase medalist, -8), Johnny Keefer, Andrew Putnam, Nick Hardy, Max McGreevy, William Mouw, John Parry, Taylor Montgomery, Dylan Wu, Chandler Phillips (1st alternate who replaced Marco Penge), Carl Yuan, Niklas Norgaard, Angel Hidalgo, Alejandro Tosti, Matthew Jordan, Nathan Kimsey (Walton Heath medalist, -14), Adrien Saddier, Laurie Canter, Matt McCarty, Cooper Dossey, Adrien Dumont de Chassart, James Nicholas (NY resident, made the cut at Oakmont 2025), Ben Kohles (won the Korn Ferry BMW Charity Pro-Am June 7), Zac Blair (Springfield co-medalist, -8), Neal Shipley (Springfield co-medalist, -8), Ben James, Preston Stout (a), Ethan Fang (a), Graeme McDowell (2010 U.S. Open champion), Pdraig Harrington (**added in correction** — 2025 U.S. Senior Open champion and three-time major winner; a recognizable name but, at 53, a likely missed cut), J.B. Holmes, Cole Hammer, Taihei Sato, Jake Sollon, Marcelo Roza, Miles Russell (a), Ryder Cowan (a), Arni Sveinsson (a), Eric Lee (a) (**added in correction** — final-qualifying amateur, America; ranked just above the status floor, low confidence), and the club-pro/amateur **status floor** (no competitive data above mini-tour/college level — bottom of tier): Mason Howell (a — *elevated within this group as reigning U.S. Amateur champion and 3-0 Walker Cup player*), Filippo Celli, Hamilton Coleman (a), Ugo Coussaud, Hennie du Plessis, Marek Fleming (a), Vaughn Harber (a), Jackson Herrington (a), Harry Higgs, Robbie Higgins, Brandon Holtz (a), T.K. Kim, Chase Kyes (a), Greyson Leach, Bryan Lee (a), Ryuichi Oiwa, Kaito Onishi, Jackson Ormond (a — Gastonia co-medalist, -12), Jake Peacock, Giuseppe Puebla (a), Mateo Pulcini (a), Logan Reilly (a), Rocco Repetto Taylor, Matthew Robles (a), Jack Schoenberger (a), Manav Shah, Jimmy Stanger (T4 at the Canadian Open), Spencer Tibbits, Jackson Van Paris, Brandon Wu.

Final-qualifier medalists / in-form secondary-tour players explicitly elevated above the journeyman pack: Chris Kirk, Davis Thompson, Emiliano Grillo, Nathan Kimsey, Kevin Roy, Neal Shipley and Zac Blair, Ben Kohles, and (within the amateur floor) Mason Howell and Jackson Ormond.

Process Notes / Overrides Applied

- **INJURY DEMOTE — Brooks Koepka (£3M → £2M).** Verified against primary sources: Koepka withdrew before the final round of the RBC Canadian Open on Sunday, June 14, 2026 (ESPN, PGA Tour). He cited an inability to grip the club — numbness in the ring and pinkie fingers of his hand. Protocol check: (1) confirmed event/date/reason from primary wire; (2) structural/neurological hand issue, **not** an illness; (3) within the 30-day window; (4) current, not historical; (5) he has **not** completed an event since and his status is uncertain. All five conditions met → demote one tier and flag as a trap. **If Koepka WDs before Thursday, remove him from the pool entirely.**
- **NO DEMOTE — Collin Morikawa (verified historical, override declined).** Morikawa's back-spasm WD occurred at THE PLAYERS on March 12, 2026 — more than three months ago and well outside the 30-day window. He has since played the Masters, RBC Heritage, the PGA Championship, and the RBC Canadian Open (June 11-14) without recurrence. Career/historical injury is not grounds for demotion. He stays at his odds-based £3M placement.
- **HOT-FORM PROMOTE — Aaron Rai (within £2M, to rank 2).** Major win at the 2026 PGA Championship = strong promote, supported by an ideal accuracy profile for Shinnecock.
- **HOT-FORM PROMOTE — Bud Cauley (within £2M, to rank 6).** Full-strength-field win at the RBC Canadian Open June 14 = moderate promote, weighed against limited major pedigree.
- **>30% book-spread flags:** Koepka (DK +2400 vs FD/BetMGM +3500); Shane Lowry. Bud Cauley was priced N/A at DraftKings at publication (he qualified just before the field closed) — his consensus is drawn from FanDuel/BetMGM.
- **Field & count verification (corrected):** $6 + 15 + 45 + 90 = 156 \checkmark$. The £1M tier was reconciled name-by-name against the official field (Golf Channel/USGA, June 15). An earlier draft inadvertently omitted three players — **Padraig Harrington** (2025 U.S. Senior Open champion), **Michael Brennan** (top-60 OWGR, May 18), and **Eric Lee (a)** (final qualifying, America) — now placed in £1M (Brennan ranked 11; Harrington and Lee in the low-confidence remainder). No player is double-listed; each appears in exactly one tier. Recent field changes incorporated: Marco Penge withdrew and Chandler Phillips (first alternate) replaced him; Bud Cauley and J.T. Poston entered via the June 15 OWGR window.

Recommendations

- **Lead build: 3-3-2-2.** With under 40% of the field reaching the weekend and worst-round-of-day penalties for missed cuts, spreading exposure across reliable cut-makers

beats top-heavy win-equity stacking. A strong template: Henley + Rose (£3M) / Matsuyama (£2M) / Sam Stevens (£1M), or Young + Hatton / English / Chris Kirk.

- **Alternative: 4-2-2-2 anchored by Scheffler.** Justified only because Scheffler is both the shortest price AND the safest cut (76-event streak); pair with two ball-strikers in £2M (Matsuyama, English) and a £1M cut-maker (Sam Stevens or Michael Kim).
- **£2M cut-security targets:** Hideki Matsuyama (12/13 U.S. Open cuts), Harris English (10/10), J.J. Spaun, Aaron Rai. **£1M cut-makers over dart throws:** Sam Stevens (3/3), Michael Kim, Chris Kirk.
- **Avoid stacking high-variance bombers** (Åberg, DeChambeau) and chronic U.S. Open cut-missers (Connors); the fescue/precision premium punishes them.
- **Benchmarks that change the plan:** (a) If Koepka or any £3M name posts a pre-tournament WD, drop them and reallocate to the same tier (free transfers at the cut can only move to same-or-lower tier, so build conservatively). (b) If the weather forecast turns benign and firm/fast chaos is reduced, the cut becomes less random — tilt toward 4-2-2-2 and lean harder on the elite anchor. (c) If wind ramps up, overweight steady ball-strikers (Fitzpatrick, Rai, Henley, Rose) over putter-dependent picks.

Caveats

- **Consensus is three-book (DraftKings / FanDuel / BetMGM).** A standalone Pinnacle line was not publicly retrievable at publication; given the tight cross-book agreement at the top, this is directionally immaterial to placement but is noted per methodology.
- **Odds compress badly at the £2M/£1M boundary** (clusters around +11000–+16000), so placements there lean increasingly on form, cut rate and OWGR/DataGolf and are lower-confidence by design.
- **£1M ranks below ~16 are largely cosmetic.** They are ordered by the fallback ladder (OWGR → DataGolf → home-tour → qualifier → status floor) with acknowledged low confidence; do not over-invest in, e.g., the 60th vs. 75th £1M player.
- **Koepka's status is fluid.** This sheet treats him as playing-but-impaired; reassess at first tee times.